



THE HONEST COMPARISON

I built the same AI agent 6 times

LangGraph vs CrewAI vs PydanticAI vs OpenAI SDK vs Smolagents vs Google ADK

LangGraph

CrewAI

PydanticAI

OpenAI SDK

Smolagents

Google ADK

And only two frameworks made my final stack.



Ashwini

Senior AI/ML Engineer

Swipe →

Which framework should I learn?

Every AI developer asks the same question. The internet says:

- LangGraph

- CrewAI

- PydanticAI

- OpenAI SDK

- Smolagents

- Google ADK

THE TRUTH?

They solve different problems.



Ashwini

Senior AI/ML Engineer



LangGraph

Best for production workflows

✓ State management

✓ Checkpointing

✓ Human approval loops

✓ Durable execution

PERFECT FOR

Enterprise workflows

Multi-step pipelines

Long-running jobs

TRADEOFF

✗ Steeper learning curve



Ashwini

Senior AI/ML Engineer



CrewAI

Best for fast multi-agent prototypes

Create teams of:



Researcher



Writer



Reviewer

PERFECT FOR

Hackathons

Demos

Quick MVPs

TRADEOFF

✗ High token usage

✗ Debugging can get messy



Ashwini

Senior AI/ML Engineer



PydanticAI

Best for backend engineers

✓ Type safety

✓ Structured outputs

✓ Pydantic validation

✓ FastAPI integration

PERFECT FOR

APIs

Extraction pipelines

Business automation

TRADEOFF

✗ No built-in orchestration



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Senior AI/ML Engineer



OpenAI SDK

Best for OpenAI ecosystems

Simple primitives:

- Agents

- Tools

- Handoffs

- Guardrails

PERFECT FOR

Tool calling

Moderate complexity workflows

TRADEOFF

✗ Smaller ecosystem



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Senior AI/ML Engineer



Smolagents

Best for open source developers

Instead of JSON tool calls...

It writes Python code.

✓ Extremely lightweight

✓ Flexible execution

TRADEOFF

✗ Requires sandboxing

✗ Security considerations matter



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Senior AI/ML Engineer



Google ADK

Best for Google Cloud teams

✓ Built-in evaluations

✓ Workflow orchestration

✓ Vertex AI integration

PERFECT FOR

Enterprise AI

GCP environments

TRADEOFF

✗ Gemini-first ecosystem



Ashwini

Senior AI/ML Engineer

🔗 PICK FAST

My decision framework

Single agent?

→ **PydanticAI**

Complex workflow?

→ **LangGraph**

Prototype by Friday?

→ **CrewAI**

OpenAI stack?

→ **OpenAI SDK**

Open source experiment?

→ **Smolagents**

Google Cloud?

→ **Google ADK**



Ashwini
Senior AI/ML Engineer

 THE BIGGEST LESSON

Framework choice **matters less** than:

1 Prompt design

2 Tool design

3 Retrieval quality

4 Observability

5 Evaluation

A great architecture beats a **trendy framework** every time.



Ashwini

Senior AI/ML Engineer

 MY PRODUCTION STACK · 2026

✓ **PydanticAI** for single-agent systems

✓ **LangGraph** for complex workflows

Everything else is situational.



What are you using for AI agents?

👉 Drop your stack below.



Ashwini
Senior AI/ML Engineer

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